

Red 4/14/00 ugd

CFO-ORC-FILE# _____

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS SIGHT RECORD FORM

Results: _____

Species:

Red-shouldered Hawk

Buteo lineatus

Dates: 3/11/00

Number of birds seen: 1

Sex: unknown

Plumage: immature

Locality: Cherry Creek State Park by model airplane field.

Elevation: about 5200 feet

Nearest town: Greenwood Village

County: Arapahoe

Time observed: around 9 am

Duration of observation: several minutes

Other observers with you: Karleen Schofield, Ira Sanders, Tammy Ellsworth, Loch Kilpatrick, Warren Finch, Ric Olson - it was a DFO field trip led by me.

Other observers who saw the bird independently:

Light conditions: Not noted.

Optical equipment: Leica 10x42 binoculars, Swarovski 80mm scope - usually zoomed to about 40 or 45 power.

Distance from bird: First perch was probably 100 feet. That is very much of a guess. It was close enough to clearly see the eye color in my scope. Second perch was probably about 200 or 300 meters. It was still close enough to fairly easily count the tail bands in my scope.

Describe the bird's behavior: It was perched in a tree near the road and then flew across the marsh to the east to some more trees and again perched. It was preening some of the time and occasionally moved a little.

Describe the bird (what you actually saw):

Head: The first thing I noticed was a heavy, dark malar stripe. The crown was a little pale and this paleness came down a little behind the eyes.

Tail: One of the reasons I stopped to look more closely at this bird was that the tail seemed long. The tip of the primaries fell on about the 2nd dark band from the tail tip. From above the tail had alternating light and dark bands. The light bands were of equal or slightly wider width than the dark. There was a very narrow white terminal band then a full-sized dark subterminal band. The undertail had a broad light terminal band and there were 8 or 9 total bands on the underside of the tail.

Bare parts: Yellow eyes, pale cere, bare legs.

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Underparts: The belly had very heavy lengthwise streaks. The breast was lighter than the belly or around the neck.

Back and shoulders: The shoulders were solid dark. The coverts were somewhat paler.

Wings: Light panels under the wings were easily seen when the bird flew and when it raised its wings while perched.

Size: There was nothing to compare it directly to, but it certainly was not eagle-sized or kestrel-sized.

Describe the bird's song and call if heard: not noted, but I think it was silent.

Describe the habitat in which you observed the bird: It was in sparse trees near a marsh.

How did you eliminate similarly appearing species:

Broad-winged Hawk (immature): Has light brown and dark tail bands - our bird had very light bands and dark bands. Lacks light wing panels.

Broad-winged Hawk (adult): Has only two light bands in tail. Lacks light wing panels.

Northern Goshawk (immature): Wingtips would not extend as far down the tail.

Red-tailed Hawk: Dark bands in tail are very narrow.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species: I have not really studied immature Red-shouldered or Broad-winged Hawks very much although I have seen many Red-shouldered Hawks in California and a few Broad-winged Hawks in the East and in Colorado in the spring.

List books if they helped in your identification: A Photographic Guide to North American Raptors, by Brian K. Wheeler and William S Clark.

This report was written from notes taken during x, or after observation or from memory. I spoke into a microcassette recorder while observing the bird and later transcribed the recording to paper.

Reporting observer:

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